

# Crater Lake: Natural Wonder [B1]

È il lago più profondo degli Stati Uniti, noto per le sue acque cristalline. Ricco di misteri, le tribù native americane locali lo considerano un luogo sacro e un portale spirituale.



“To say that this wonderful lake is [grand](#), beyond description, is to give an idea of its magnificence. Everyone [gazes](#) at it in almost [tearful astonishment](#).” With this [quote](#), the Crater Lake Institute provides a sense of the beauty of Crater Lake, which is the deepest lake in the US. Situated in Crater Lake National Park in Oregon, the lake is around 1,949 feet (594m) deep, and is known for its magnificent deep blue color and the clarity of its waters.

## A BALANCING ACT

About 7,700 years ago, the volcano Mount Mazama experienced a massive eruption that caused the [summit](#) to implode. [Debris](#) and lava collapsed into the [emptied](#) magma chamber, and this created the caldera that then filled with water to form Crater Lake. Unlike most lakes, Crater Lake is hydrologically closed: it has no [streams flowing](#) into or out of it. Instead, it is filled entirely by precipitation caused by rain and snow. The lake's water level remains stable over time because the amount of water entering is balanced by the amount lost through evaporation and underground [seepage](#).

## SACRED SITE

Even before Mount Mazama collapsed, the Klamath Tribes, a Native American Nation, lived in the area. The Klamath people are the source of many mysterious stories about the volcano and the lake. They say a battle between Llao, the god of the [underworld](#), and Skell, the god of the sky, caused the volcano to collapse. They consider the lake not only a sacred place, but a spiritual portal. Places

Jasper National Park: Staying Safe in Bear Country Per osservare gli orsi nel loro habitat naturale, la miglior destinazione nel Nord America è sicuramente il Canada. Andiamo a Jasper, nelle Rocky Mountains. Chuck Rolando

## THE OLD MAN OF THE LAKE

One of the biggest mysteries of Crater Lake is the Old Man of the Lake, a tree [stump](#) that has been floating vertically across its water for over a hundred years! The [stump](#) is over thirty feet (9.14m) long, with about four feet (1.22m) [rising](#) above the water's surface. Incredibly, it can travel significant distances, even against the wind, and has been known to travel nearly four miles in a day. This has fascinated scientists and visitors, and inspired many rumours, with some believing that the [stump](#) can control the weather.

## TWO ISLANDS AND A NEWT

Also [rising](#) above the surface of Crater Lake are two islands: [Wizard](#) Island, which resembles a wizard's hat, and can be visited in the summer months; and Phantom Ship, which resembles a ship, but is sometimes obscured by weather conditions, [hence](#) its [eerie](#) name. The lake is also one of the few places in the world where you can find the Mazama [newt](#), a type of salamander that also lives in Alaska, which you might see swimming in the lake's clear waters, or sitting under a rock at its [edge](#).

---

# Glossary

- **gazes** = fissare
- **tearful astonishment** = stupore commosso
- **summit** = vetta
- **Debris** = detriti, macerie
- **flowing** = fluire
- **stump** = ceppo, tronco
- **emptied** = svuotare
- **seepage** = infiltrazione
- **hence** = da cui
- **newt** = tritone
- **edge** = riva
- **grand** = magnifico
- **streams** = ruscelli
- **quote** = citazione
- **underworld** = inferi
- **eerie** = inquietante
- **rising** = elevarsi
- **Wizard** = mago